

Philipp Hilbert. *Platform-first Product Owner for B2B subscription infrastructure.*

Positioning, nearly ten years translating complex operational workflows into scalable B2B software systems, now focused on internal platforms and subscription logic.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

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§ WHY ZERTIFICON

Zertificon is building something genuinely rare: a profitable, owner-led German security company that solves real compliance problems for real businesses, without the noise of a VC growth cycle. The posting calls for someone who can own a central operations platform that sits at the intersection of subscription logic, licensing state machines, middleware, and internal tooling – precisely the kind of cross-cutting systems work where requirements live in three departments simultaneously and break when nobody owns the seams. The explicit callout of virtual product and software subscription experience over classical ERP tells me the team has been burned before by POs who modelled SKUs when they should have been modelling entitlement states and renewal triggers. *That exact distinction is where my strongest work has lived.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

My hands-on experience with dedicated enterprise licensing platforms (e.g. Flexera, Zuora) is limited; I have not administered one as a system administrator. What I do bring is product ownership of systems with equivalent structural complexity – subscription state machines, entitlement transitions, data provenance chains – designed from requirements through to production, where the logic lived in my backlog and my documentation.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting and edge-case generation
- **GPT**, stakeholder summaries and documentation passes
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo spec and acceptance-criteria work
- **Cursor/VSCode**, codebase navigation and lightweight implementation
- **Lovable**, rapid UI mockup and prototype iteration
- **Framer**, design-heavy workflow visualisations
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-facing documentation and decks
- **n8n**, operational workflow automation prototyping

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Redpanda, MicroStrategy, Ionic, AngularJS, low-code insurance platform.

§ SIDE PROJECT

QCRYPT AG ENCRYPTION PRODUCT [YOUTUBE.COM/WATCH?](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NT06F71LGFE)
V=NT06F71LGFE →

Quantum-secure OTP encryption platform, co-founded and owned as Product Owner from concept to market.

- Defined product architecture for backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption flows built on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware.
- Designed for setup under two minutes with no technical knowledge required – security product usability was the core constraint.
- Served concurrently as deputy IT security officer, bridging product decisions with attack-vector and compliance considerations.
- Directly relevant here: owned a security-oriented B2B software product end-to-end, with no physical product logic and full focus on entitlement, key state, and operational correctness.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT ZERTIFICON

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow every stakeholder team that feeds into the platform – licensing, ops, finance, support – and document the current state of each subscription and licence state transition in a visual flow before writing a single story.

WEEK 2

Triage and slice.

Walk the existing backlog with the development team, identify which items are blocked by unclear acceptance criteria versus genuine technical unknowns, and produce the first clean set of ready-to-refine stories.

WEEK 3+

Ship and stabilise.

Close the first iteration loop on a defined monitoring or automation thread, establish a lightweight KPI dashboard for stakeholder visibility, and embed a recurring feedback cadence with ops and the partner portal PO.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Zertificon team,

I am applying for the Product Owner role on your Business Management Platform. The combination of a profitable, owner-led security company, an explicitly internal operations tool with real subscription and licensing complexity, and a team that distinguishes virtual product logic from classical ERP tells me this is a role where the work is genuinely precise – and where imprecision has a visible cost.

My most directly relevant experience is at Rohde & Schwarz, where I owned a central AI data management platform for the FCAS defence programme. That platform was the operational interface between data scientists, ML engineers, backend teams, QA, and multinational stakeholders. My job was to hold the state model – how datasets moved from raw ingestion through transformation, tagging, and audit trail – and translate it into reliable delivery. I wrote the stories, owned the acceptance criteria, unblocked infrastructure issues independently

(including a feature the project lead had been requesting for over a year, which I delivered in a week), and managed the GitOps rollout. At Emil Group I rebuilt delivery discipline for a B2B InsurTech platform from near-collapse: split a 17-person team into scrum units with clear ownership, reintroduced velocity tracking, and ran weekly client workshops to rebuild trust in a prototype-stage environment – all while continuing to ship Claims Center from concept to production.

What the Zertificon posting describes – backlog ownership, requirements translation from business and ops teams, technical documentation of data models and state transitions, monitoring and alerting, close collaboration with a second PO on a related portal – maps directly to how I have worked across those roles. I am comfortable with Jira and Confluence as daily tooling. I can read and reason about APIs, webhooks, and middleware without being the one implementing them. I produce mockups in Figma or equivalent when a story needs a visual anchor, not as an aesthetic exercise.

On the subscription and licensing specificity: my background at Qcrypt AG, where I co-founded and owned a security software product built entirely on virtual entitlements and device-bound key states, and at Emil Group, where the entire platform value was in configuration-driven insurance product logic with no physical fulfilment, means I think naturally in terms of states, transitions, and edge cases rather than warehouse quantities. That mental model transfers directly to what you are building.

One thing I noticed in your posting: you mention that if a candidate finds Edward Snowden acted correctly as a whistleblower, you may share the same values – and you donate to a supporting organisation after a passed probationary period. I do share that view. Snowden's disclosures shifted a generation's understanding of surveillance infrastructure, and I think the decision to make them took both moral clarity and significant personal cost. The fact that a security company in Berlin would encode that conviction into its hiring process tells me more about the culture than any benefits list.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Hands-on Product Manager and Product Owner with nearly ten years of experience translating complex operational workflows into scalable B2B software systems. Background spans internal operations platforms, regulated environments, AI data infrastructure, and founder-level company building. Proven track record owning state-machine-heavy products – entitlement

flows, transformation pipelines, insurance configuration logic – end-to-end from discovery through GitOps rollout. Fluent in the technical context of APIs, middleware, microservices, and Kubernetes-based deployments without being the one writing the code. Low ego, high agency, and comfortable in environments where requirements arrive incomplete and clarity is the PO's job to create.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Subscription and licence logic modelling for virtual B2B software products
 - Translating operational complexity into dev-ready stories and data-model documentation
 - Backlog management, sprint discipline, and velocity recovery under delivery pressure
 - Cross-functional stakeholder alignment across business, engineering, QA, and compliance
 - Technical fluency in APIs, microservices, Kubernetes, and ETL pipelines
 - Internal platform ownership with KPI visibility and monitoring focus
 - AI-native product execution: rapid prototyping, LLM-assisted spec work
 - Workshop moderation and client trust rebuilding in prototype-stage environments
 - Founder-level pragmatism: scoped delivery under ambiguity and incomplete requirements
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Owned end-to-end delivery of a central AI data management platform (government contract, FCAS programme): defined state model for dataset ingestion, transformation, tagging, and audit trails
- Delivered autonomous feature sets from user stories through acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout
- Unblocked infrastructure-level issues in OpenShift independently; delivered a feature the project lead had been requesting for over a year – completed in one week
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Led cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA; responsible for data provenance and auditability with multinational stakeholders

Tech: Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redpanda, Kubernetes, Argo Workflows, ArgoCD, OpenShift

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Owned backlog and delivery for the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform; shipped labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV) with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage

Tech: Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Kubernetes, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Owned product for a B2B InsurTech platform reducing insurance product time-to-market from over one year to under one week, serving primary insurers, reinsurers, MGAs, brokers, and underwriters
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Re-established sprint discipline: split a 17-person team into scoped Scrum units, introduced ownership and deputy concepts, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops; reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

Tech: Low-code platform, Java, HTML/CSS, Kubernetes, REST APIs

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage on iOS and Android
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of technical complexity including legacy APIs and external database dependencies
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows

Tech: AngularJS, Ionic, Python, Kubernetes, CGM API integration

BUNDESDRUCKEREI 2021, 2021

Product Owner, COVID-19 Data Platform

- Owned RKI projects DIM and DESH: secure data structures and identity management under strict data governance and compliance requirements
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AOK HEALTH INSURANCE – ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Led migration of internal webshop to Shopware including complex catalogue and API integration and customisable approval policies for a healthcare procurement workflow
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§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Co-Founder, Product Owner

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product built on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware; designed for setup under two minutes with no technical knowledge required
- Served concurrently as deputy IT security officer; bridged product decisions with attack-vector analysis and compliance framing
- Delivered English-language product promotion independently (video sample: [youtube.com/watch?v=nt06f71lgfE](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nt06f71lgfE))

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder, CFO

- Built a group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone; owned PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype; later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO, CFO, Head of HR

- Established digital tooling, financial and investment planning, ERP introduction, and HR infrastructure for an agri-tech startup from founding through growth stage

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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